

enjoyable, and it made me realize how few “big games” there really are.

This pattern is common in the FI community. When Brad and Jonathan interviewed Jeff, *The Happy Philosopher*, on the *ChooseFI* podcast, he described burnout and general unhappiness with his demanding job as a physician as his original reason to pursue early retirement. Because of his high income, the path to early retirement in a short period was easier for him than for most. He just had to save a high percentage of his large income. But it still would take five to ten years to reach FI. He needed to focus on finding happiness immediately.

He took multiple actions but cited one as being particularly important to increase happiness long before reaching FI. Previously, Jeff followed the news closely and got “tied up in the gloom and doom.” He watched a lot of sports, again focusing on things he had no control over. So he decided to simply stop watching. He soon found that cutting these things out of his life reduced stress greatly, a major step in emerging from burnout before achieving FI and leaving his demanding career.

Choosing FI means deciding to be different from those on the standard path through life. This requires questioning things that most